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To whom it may concern at NSF: The ongoing Generative AI revolution has the potential to significantly enhance the lives of autistic people by solving critical issues facing many people with disabilities, including autism spectrum disorder (ASD). The largest impact for this demographic exists in the services industry, such as personal communication, K-12 and higher education, and general social involvement across all stages of life. Large Language Models (LLMs) and similar AI technologies have already been shown to improve social interaction, create individualized learning experiences, and close the communication gap between autistic and neurotypical people. Still more work needs to be done to fulfill the promise of innovation. In my opinion, generative AI as a tool for the service industry ought to be developed and possibly regulated in active collaboration with the autistic community. Many promises of AI aren't necessarily designed to meet the unique needs of autistic individuals. Many autistic individuals don't struggle with social connection because they lack the desire to engage with others, but because traditional communication norms weren't built with neurodiverse perspectives in mind. AI-powered tools can help bridge this gap by offering real-time support in interpreting social cues, suggesting contextually appropriate responses, and making interactions smoother. In education, AI can adapt to different learning styles, allowing for flexible pacing and multimodal approaches that make information more accessible and engaging. The success of generative AI as a social tool depends on how much weight is given to autistic perspectives and how directly autistic people are involved in its development. Too often, well-intentioned interventions fall short because they are designed from a neurotypical perspective rather than being informed by the actual lived experiences of autistic individuals. Generative AI should be used to help autistic people as they are, rather than forcing them to conform to neurotypical norms. For example, AI-powered social coaching tools should prioritize allowing autistic users to interact in ways that are comfortable for them, rather than encouraging them to "mask" or conceal their natural tendencies. Privacy and data security are also important considerations. Many autistic people rely on artificial intelligence (AI) for delicate or intensely intimate interactions, such as social practice, mental health assistance, and business communication. AI models must be built, developed, and deployed with total transparency and fairness. Transparency protocols ensure AI models are utilized properly by Americans, and aren't unintentionally harming our most vulnerable. The National Science Foundation has played an important role in developing AI research for the public good. By directing funds, resources, and expertise toward AI initiatives that address the unique needs of autistic Americans, the National Science Foundation can help ensure that technological innovation benefits those who need it most. This is an important time in AI development. Thoughtful, inclusive research could change generative AI from a white-collar productivity tool into a product that actively supports independence, self advocacy, accessibility, and inclusion. NSF support will ensure AI is molded into a force that amplifies neurodivergent voices, making technology more flexible, responsive, and in tune with real-world needs. Noah Weinberger